join Netanyahu for some hefty reward (defense minister and vice prime minister?). Of course, this is merely wild speculation.

Let me return to yesterday's remark about Israel being a caste-like society. Don't think, for example, that the distinction between sabras and others was sufficient. Not at all. Among the sabras, there was a clear distinction between the children from kibbutzim and those from cities, the kibbutz being the perceived aristocracy (and within that category, there was a competition between the oldest kibbutzim, the Deganias, and some very old and famous village cooperatives, Nahalal). This turned into distinctions between the units in which you served in the army, etc. Nowadays, it is more a matter of tribes: the North Africans, the Russians, the Ethiopians, the Yemenites, the *yekes* (the Germans; the appellation dates from the 1930s and stems probably from the German word *Jacke*, "jacket"), the Israeli Arabs, and so on. There is intermarriage, of course, mainly among the Jewish tribes, but the distinctions are far from having been eliminated.

One may argue that these kinds of distinctions are pretty common in any Western nation created by, depending on, or dealing with immigration—and in many Eastern nations, too. Quite true, but for a nation under constant siege like Israel, relatively subdued social resentment may become an existential issue.

Thursday, April 20

Defense Minister Gallant warned today that Iran was extremely close to the production of nuclear material for military use. Moreover, for Israel, the next war will have to be fought simultaneously on all fronts. Not good news, but expected for some time. The big question: will the US stand with Israel in a major emergency? Biden's distaste for Netanyahu is quite obvious and the pressure from the "Progressives" in the Democratic Party against any pro-Israeli involvement will be fierce.